

Minutes

April 30, 2022

Town meeting was called to order at 9:19 by Moderator, Larry Farber, a quorum being deemed present.

A tribute to Julie Shively was given for her 12 years as a Select Board member. Several announcements were given and a moment of silence was held.

Article One: To choose all necessary Town officers to serve for periods prescribed by law or Town bylaw, or take any action relative thereto.

The Moderator read the list of offices up for election and took nominations from the floor.

Assessors: Cat Ford and Sam Black nominated for two positions and elected by voice vote.

Board of Health: Barbara Kline Seamon nominated for one position and elected by voice vote.

Constable: Tom Masterton nominated for one position and elected by voice vote.

Finance Committee: Steve Nagy, Bethany Seeger and Phil Carter nominated for two positions. Paper ballot used for contested race. Bethany Seeger: 91; Phil Carter: 76 and Steve Nagy 34.

Library Trustees: Seth Seeger and Judith Davidov were nominated for two positions and elected by a voice vote.

Planning Board: Eswan Keyes was nominated for one position and elected by a voice vote.

School Committee: Jya Plavin and Tilman Wolf were nominated for two positions and elected by a voice vote.

Select Board: Pat Duffy was elected for one position by a voice vote.

Article Two: To see if the Town will vote to amend Section VI of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement by replacing subsection j) as follows: "For Fiscal Year 2023 only, the alternative operating budget assessment shall be calculated as a five-year average of minimum contributions with the remainder of the assessment allocated to the member towns in accordance with the per-pupil method found in Section VI e) of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement. Additionally, if any member town's assessment based on this method increases or decreases more than 4% from their Fiscal Year 2022 assessment, the Fiscal Year 2023 assessment shall be limited to a 4% change provided that the requirements of Minimum Local Contribution are still met. The five-year average of minimum contributions will include the five most recent years.", or take any other action relative thereto.

Article Two: (___Julie___) I move that the Town vote to amend Section VI of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement by replacing subsection j) as follows: "For Fiscal Year 2023 only, the alternative operating budget assessment shall be calculated as a five-year average of minimum contributions with the remainder of the assessment allocated to the member towns in accordance with the per-pupil method found in Section VI e) of the Amherst Pelham Regional School District Agreement. Additionally, if any member town's assessment based on this method increases or decreases more than 4% from their Fiscal Year 2022 assessment, the Fiscal Year 2023 assessment shall be limited to a 4% change provided that the requirements of Minimum Local Contribution are still met. The five-year average of minimum contributions will include the five most recent years."

Seconded. Carries unanimously.

Article Three: To see if the Town will vote to raise and appropriate or

transfer from available

funds such sums of money as shall be necessary to meet Town expenses, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Three: (___Tom___) I move that the town vote to raise and appropriate or transfer from available funds such sums of money as shall be necessary to meet town expenses for the ensuing fiscal year from the following sources: raise and appropriate the sum of \$6,825,580; transfer the sum of \$10,00 from account #712 for the Fiber Optic construction; and transfer the sum of \$1,744 from Bond Premiums Reserved.

Moderator reads from the abbreviated budget allowing time for voters to ?hold? line items for which they have questions. Select Board Expenses is held by Tom Wolff to ask for the budget and warrant for ATM to be mailed to every house next year. Lisa addresses Town Meeting to state that the Newsletter budget was reduced, not cut, allowing for that.

Seconded. Unheld budget carries unanimously.

Vote on held Select Board Expenses (\$6,288.00) carries unanimously.

Total FY 23 budget of \$6,837,324 carries unanimously.

Article Four: To see if the Town will vote to set the salaries of elected officials as provided by MGL Chapter 41, Section 108, to be made effective from July 1, 2022 as presented in the budget, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Four: (___Melissa___) I move that the Town vote to set the salaries of elected officials as provided by MGL Chapter 41, Section 108, to be made effective from July 1, 2022 as presented in the budget.

Seconded. Carries unanimously.

Article Five: To see if the Town will vote to transfer the sum of \$55,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new hybrid electric/gasoline police cruiser, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Five: (___Julie___) I move that the Town vote to transfer the sum of \$55,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new hybrid electric/gasoline police cruiser.

Chief Minckler and Wes Goscenski of Capital Planning answer questions.

Seconded. Carries unanimously.

Article Six: To see if the Town will vote to transfer the sum of \$77,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new medium sized dump truck for the Highway Department, or take any action relative thereto.

Article Six: (___Tom___) I move that the Town vote to transfer the sum of \$77,000 from the Stabilization Account to purchase and equip a new medium sized dump truck for the Highway Department.

Seconded. Carries unanimously.

Article Seven: To see if the Town will vote to transfer from Free Cash the sum of \$41,000 into the Stabilization Account to fund the Capital Plan, or take any action relative thereto.